03-16 第一篇

The Story of the Bicycle

Bicycles are such a common sight today that it is hard to imagine a world without them. [1] However, the invention of this amazing two-wheeled machine actually took many years and involved several creative inventors.

The story began in 1817 when a German inventor built the first "running machine". This early bicycle was made entirely of wood and had no pedals (踏板). [2] It was certainly not very fast, but it was the very first step toward modern cycling.

Decades later, in the 1860s, French inventors added pedals to the front wheel. This new design was called the "boneshaker" for a very good reason. [3] Riding it on rough stone streets was an extremely uncomfortable and bumpy experience! Despite the pain, it became quite popular in Europe.

In the 1870s, the design changed again to the "high-wheel" bicycle, which had a huge front wheel and a tiny back wheel. [4] Because the rider sat so high up, falling off could lead to serious injuries.

Finally, in the late 1880s, the "safety bicycle" was introduced. It featured two wheels of the same size and a metal chain to drive the back wheel. [5] Since then, the basic shape of the bicycle has remained mostly the same, providing cheap and healthy transportation for millions of people worldwide.

选项

A. This allowed the bicycle to move much faster with significantly less effort. B. To move forward, the rider had to push against the ground with their feet. C. Therefore, most people decided to stop riding bicycles immediately. D. Its frame was made of heavy iron, and its wheels had no rubber tires. E. We see people riding them to school, to work, or just for fun in the park. F. While it was much faster, it was also incredibly dangerous to ride.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] E [2] B [3] D [4] F [5] A

深度解析

- **[1] E：**

- **线索**：语境顺承与现象阐述。空前首句说到："如今自行车太常见了，很难想象没有它们的世界"。E选项"We see people riding them to school, to work, or just for fun in the park"（我们看到人们骑着它们去上学、上班，或者只是在公园里为了好玩）正是对前文"common sight（常见景象）"的最具体展现。紧随其后的"However（然而），这台惊人的两轮机器的发明实际上花了很多年"，构成了从"现在司空见惯"到"过去发明不易"的完美跨越。代词"them"指代首句的"Bicycles"。

- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：逻辑呼应与动作解释。空前提到1817年第一辆"奔跑机器"完全由木头制成，并且"had no pedals（没有踏板）"。既然没有踏板，那怎么骑呢？B选项"To move forward, the rider had to push against the ground with their feet"（为了向前移动，骑手必须用脚蹬地）正好完美回答了这个问题。同时，这也顺承了空后的句子："它当然不是跑得很快..."（用脚蹬当然不快）。

- **[3] D**：
  - **线索**：因果解释与具象化描述。空前提到1860年代加了踏板的自行车被叫做"boneshaker（震骨机/碎骨机）"，且说这个名字"有充分的理由"。D选项"Its frame was made of heavy iron, and its wheels had no rubber tires"（它的车架是重铁做的，轮子没有橡胶轮胎）正是"震骨"这一物理原因的深入剖析。正因为铁架子加无减震的硬轮子，才引发了空后那句必然结果："在颠簸的石板路上骑它是一次极其不舒服和颠簸的经历"。

- **[4] F**：
  - **线索**：对比转折与结构铺垫。空前介绍了1870年代前大后小的"高轮（high-wheel）"自行车。F选项"While it was much faster, it was also incredibly dangerous to ride"（虽然它快得多，但骑起来也极其危险）。一方面，"大轮子"在物理上确实带来了更快的速度（顺承）；另一方面，"dangerous（危险）"一词，完美引出了空后那句具体的危险阐述："因为骑手坐得这么高，掉下来可能导致重伤"。

- **[5] A**：
  - **线索**：同义解释与承前启后。空前提到"安全自行车"有两个同样大小的轮子以及"a metal chain to drive the back wheel（一条驱动后轮的金属链条）"。A选项"This allowed the bicycle to move much faster with significantly less effort"（这使得自行车能够毫不费力地移动得快得多），其中代词"This"指代的就是上一句这个链条驱动后轮的伟大设计。这一设计让自行车变得真正安全又好骑，从而顺理成章地引出了段落尾句："从那时起，……为全世界数百万民众提供廉价健康的交通工具"。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **C. Therefore, most people decided to stop riding bicycles immediately.**：此项带有"Therefore（因此）"等总结性词汇和"bicycles"，考生极易因为第3、4空前后的"不舒服（uncomfortable）"、"危险（dangerous）"等负面词汇而顺势推

导。但是这违背了事实逻辑和上下文意思：例如第三段末尾明确说了“Despite the pain, it became quite popular...（尽管痛苦，它变得很受欢迎）”。历史发展的真相是人们不断改良它而不是停止骑行，此干扰项用反历史、反逻辑的概念制造了陷阱。